The Journey of Curiosity and Code

An Autobiography of Levis Kinyua Murithi

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Introduction & Roots in Nyeri

- Born and raised in Nyeri, Kenya.
- Grew up in a community that valued education, hard work, and togetherness.
- Developed an early curiosity for how things worked, often dismantling electronics.
- Learned foundational values: integrity, perseverance, and community support.

Early Education & The Tech Spark

- Excelled in Mathematics and Sciences during primary school.
- First encounter with a computer ignited a lifelong passion for technology.
- Transitioned to High School with a clear focus on Physics and Computer Studies.
- Participated in science clubs and built a basic LAN, solidifying career aspirations in IT.

Academic Journey at DeKUT

- Pursuing a Bachelor of Science in Information Technology.
- Transitioned from passive learning to active problem-solving (Java, Python, JavaScript).
- Gained deep theoretical and practical knowledge in networking and IoT.
- Learned self-reliance, accountability, and the importance of professional networking.

IT Support & Networking Experience

- Interned at Othaya Level 4 Hospital providing critical IT support to NHIF staff.
- Served as IT Assistant for Mathira Constituency, managing computer labs.
- Completed an 8-week industrial attachment with an ISP.
- Gained hands-on experience in fiber optic splicing, residential deployments, and network topologies.

The AI Awakening

- Explored Artificial Intelligence, NLP, and machine learning independently.
- Deployed quantized GGUF language models locally (e.g., Gemma 2) using llama.cpp on Kali Linux.
- Worked as a Freelance Technical Specialist in AI Data Annotation and RLHF.
- Specialized in Technical Prompt Engineering and Software Quality Assurance for LLMs.

Capstone & Technical Projects

- AgriTrack: A cross-platform marketplace connecting farmers with commercial buyers (React Native, NestJS).
- Virtualization Lab: Built a home lab using KVM/QEMU, running Proxmox, Windows Server, and pfSense/OPNsense.
- Cybersecurity: Practiced offensive security using Burp Suite, Nmap, and Metasploitable.
- Built a modern, interactive web-based developer portfolio.

Challenges & Personal Growth

- Overcame the steep learning curve of mastering networking, full-stack dev, and AI simultaneously.
- Navigated broken configurations and hardware limitations through gritty, command-line troubleshooting.
- Balanced rigorous academic coursework with demanding freelance commitments.
- Developed a resilient, self-reliant engineering mindset.

Beyond the Code: Interests & Philosophy

- Find inspiration in hip-hop (J. Cole) and Japanese anime (Bleach, Naruto).
- Maintain physical well-being through a strict high-protein Kenyan diet and fitness routine.
- Tweak local audio processing environments (PipeWire) as a technical hobby.
- Philosophy: True mastery requires understanding fundamentals and the courage to build from scratch.

Future Aspirations

- Aim to secure a core role at the intersection of AI alignment and infrastructure security.
- Plan to expand AgriTrack into a commercially viable product to empower Kenyan farmers.
- Pursue advanced cybersecurity certifications (e.g., OSCP).
- Goal: To become a technical leader, mentoring engineers and advocating for robust digital infrastructure in Africa.